

Guide to Ergonomics



Purpose:

This document provides you with information on how to:

- Set up your work station ergonomically
- Use safe and healthy practices while working on a computer.

Instructions:

- Read the guide carefully.
- Refer to the guide to make sure you are using safe practices while sitting at your desk and working on a computer.
- Report any issues to your manager immediately.
- Ask your manager if you have any questions or concerns, or if you need help.

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Office chair

- Use a height-adjustable chair.
- Adjust the height of your chair so that your feet rest comfortably on the floor.
- Adjust the back of your chair so you can keep a proper posture and take the pressure off your back.
- When you are sitting down, make sure that:
 - Your knees are about level with your hips
 - The seat of your chair does not press into the back of your knees.
- Keep your backbone straight and your shoulders back. If you need to, place a cushion between the curve of your lower back and the back of the chair.

Stand-alone monitor

If you are using a stand-alone monitor:

- The monitor should be roughly an arm's length away.
- The top of the screen should be at eye level or just below so that you look down at your work at a slight angle.

Stand-alone keyboard

If you are using a stand-alone keyboard:

- You should be able to have your forearms almost horizontal and your wrists straight when you are using the keyboard.
- Your elbows should be close to your body.

- You should align your keyboard with the monitor.
- You may use a wrist rest to make sure your wrists have sufficient support.

Mouse

If you are using a mouse:

- Keep your wrist in a neutral position.
- Make sure the mouse fits the size of your hand so that it is comfortable to work with.

Desk area/workspace

- Your desk area/workspace should be deep enough to accommodate your laptop/monitor at the appropriate distance.
- Make sure everything you need is within reach so that you don't have to stretch for things.
- Make sure cords do not clutter your desk and are neatly out of sight.

Laptop computers

If you work with a laptop:

- Try to connect the laptop to stand-alone equipment such as a stand-alone monitor, keyboard and mouse.

If these items are not available:

- Use a slanting laptop stand to give your wrists sufficient support.
- Tilt the laptop screen back so that you don't have to bend or crane your neck.

Minimising fatigue

- Keep correct posture at all times.
- Take short, frequent breaks.
- Move around and mix up your tasks during the day.
- Stretch your neck, shoulders, wrists, back and ankles several times during the day.